

DIRECTIONS:

Assess *your* analysis essay using the following rubric. Highlight the sections/statements that best describe your performance in each category of the rubric. At the conclusion of the rubric give yourself an overall grade. Highlight and type directly into this document.

FENCES: Literary Analysis Essay Rubric

	Sizzling A A-	Pretty Toasty B+ B B-	Lukewarm C+ C C-	Cold Fish D+ D
Analysis	Shows thorough, insightful, and highly perceptive understanding of the text's big ideas, characters, conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Delivers insightful,, well supported analysis and crafts argument seamlessly. extensive commentary that goes beyond the obvious essay creates new thinking and understanding of text uses academic language	Shows thorough and complete understanding of the text's big ideas, characters, conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Explains quotes and illustrates complex connection between quotes and thesis. Spends most of the paper analyzing literary devices and developing ideas in a well-crafted, well-supported argument.	Shows some understanding of the text's big ideas, character's conflicts, nuances, or unanswered questions. Paper moves past summary into analysis. Understanding of the text is evident. Analysis supports your argument, but ideas are obvious and basic.	Shows little to no understanding of the text. Does not construct a complex argument. Analysis is unclear. Ideas lack development or show a misunderstanding of prompt or text. May present an illogical argument or analysis; does not support thesis. Only a summary is present.
Thesis	Constructs a highly original, probing, insightful thesis, and the argument is connected to a theme in the text.	Constructs a strong complex thesis and argument that goes beneath the surface but does not probe as deeply. Is connected to a theme in the text.	Constructs a simplistic thesis and argument that may state the obvious.	Does not construct a complex thesis argument.
Textual Evidence	Selects highly insightful, persuasive evidence that clearly supports the thesis. Gives succinct, clear context for the quotations used. Analyzes evidence insightfully and clearly explains its significance as it relates to thesis. Integrates evidence smoothly into overall commentary. Cites evidence using correct MLA formatting.	Selects strong evidence that clearly supports the thesis. Gives, clear context for the quotations used. Analyzes evidence clearly and explains its significance as it relates to thesis. Integrates evidence smoothly into overall commentary. Cites evidence using correct MLA formatting.	Selects adequate evidence that supports the thesis. Gives some context for the quotations used. Analyzes evidence on a superficial level and may lack connections to thesis and/or topic sentences. Integration of evidence into overall commentary is not seamless or cohesive. May be some errors in MLA formatting of quotes.	Does not select evidence that supports the thesis. Does not give context for the quotations used. Does not analyze evidence, may summarize each quote instead. Makes little attempt at MLA formatting of quotes and citations.
Paragraph	Each body paragraph in the	Each body paragraph in the	Most body paragraphs	Body paragraphs do not

Focus and Organization	essay has a topic sentence that states a central idea and clearly relates to the thesis of the essay. Ideas are presented seamlessly and clearly. Transitions between ideas and paragraphs are seamless and advance the argument logically. Paper's overall structure is logical, clear, and exceptionally easy to follow.	essay has a topic sentence that states a central argument, but it may not always be clear how that argument relates to the thesis of the essay. Ideas are presented logically and clearly. Transitions are used between ideas and paragraphs in a way that advances argument. Paper's overall structure is logical and easy to follow.	have a topic sentence, but some of these may state a fact or example rather than an idea. Ideas are presented in somewhat logical fashion, although some parts are confusing. Some transitions are used between ideas and paragraphs. Paper's overall structure is somewhat logical and easy to follow.	each have a central argument and/or it is unclear how body paragraphs relate to the thesis of the essay. Ideas are presented erratically with no apparent thought to organization. Few or no transitions between ideas and paragraphs are used. There is no apparent logical order to the paper's overall structure.
Introduction and Conclusion	Essay has an effective introduction that captures the interest of the reader, shows why the topic is relevant, and gives the information needed to understand the thesis. The conclusion restates the writer's argument successfully and makes a compelling appeal to the reader.	Essay has a clear introduction that gives the information needed to understand the thesis. The conclusion summarizes the writer's argument but may not add anything compelling to that argument.	Essay has an introduction, but it does not capture the reader's attention and/or does not give enough information for the reader to understand the thesis. The conclusion gives an incomplete restatement of the writer's argument.	Essay has only a minimal introduction and/or conclusion.
Clarity	Writing consists of complete sentences, with no run-ons or fragments. Writing includes sophisticated sentence structure and academic language. Writing is free from grammar and spelling errors. Writing avoids repetition and uses clear, interesting vocabulary.	Writing may have one or two errors in sentence structure, grammar or spelling. Or the writing may use repetitive or unclear vocabulary. Writing includes academic language and varied sentence structure.	There are more than one or two errors in sentence structure, grammar or spelling, and/or the word choice in the writing lacks clarity. Writing does not use specific vocabulary and academic language.	Errors in sentence structure, grammar and spelling make the writing difficult to understand. Slang may be prevalent in the essay.
Process and Use of Resources	The writing shows engagement and investment in all stages of writing, from freewriting through final draft. Writer has taken risks, carefully considered feedback, and made significant changes and improvements from draft to draft.	The writing shows participation in all stages of writing, from freewriting through final draft. Writer has considered feedback and made some improvements from draft to draft.	The writing shows that the writer participated in some but not all stages of the writing process. There are minor changes from draft to draft.	Writer did not participate in most stages of the the writing process. There is little to no evidence that the writer considered feedback or made improvements from draft to draft.

Overall Grade

Student:

Instructor: